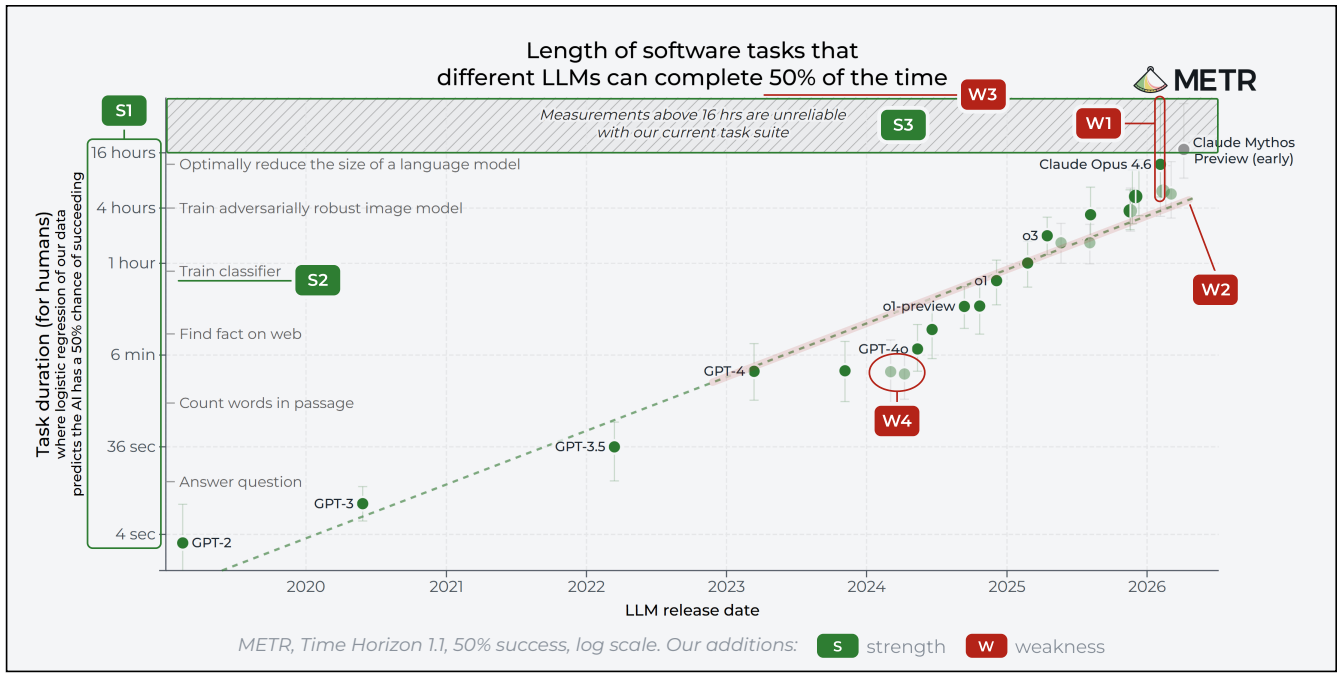
METR's Time Horizon Chart Is Easy to Read, and Easy to Overread

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Original chart | Dataset | METR analysis code



Strengths

S1 Log scale makes doubling a straight line
Steady growth reads as a steady slope, through position on a common scale, the most accurate channel (L4). Ratios also fit Weber's law (L4).

S2 Example tasks give the axis meaning
"Train classifier" at about an hour turns minutes into kinds of work, a conceptual unit (data models, L2).

S3 It marks where its data stops
Hatching and the gray Mythos dot pop out preattentively (L4), so the chart claims nothing its tasks cannot measure (expressiveness, L2).

Weaknesses

W1 Uncertainty is drawn at 20% opacity
Opus 4.6 reads as 12 h, yet its 95% CI spans 5 to 61 h. Faint whiskers sink into the ground (L5). **Fix:** solid CI bars.

W2 One straight line hides a bend
Every frontier model since o3 sits above METR's line. Continuity (L5) reads it as one pace. **Fix:** add the recent fit.

W3 "50%" carries the headline
At 80% success Opus 4.6 drops from 12 h to 70 min, yet the threshold sits only in the title and a rotated label (L4). **Fix:** plot both.

W4 Light and split dots go unexplained
No key for light green, 10 of 26 models named, two models share one split dot (expressiveness, L2). **Fix:** key and jitter.

Marks and channels

● **Point**	one AI model (26 in all)	→ **x position**	release date	Q interval
I **Vertical line**	95% bootstrap CI	↑ **y position, log**	50% horizon (human min)	Q ratio
---- **Dashed line**	METR's exponential fit	**Whisker length**	width of the CI	Q ratio
▨ **Hatched area**	above 16 h	●● **Luminance**	frontier at release or not	N
Aa **Text**	model and task names	**Gray hue, texture**	beyond the 16 h ceiling	N

Our reanalysis

Since o3, every frontier model sits **above** METR's line. A fit from 2024 on doubles every **105 days** (METR: 188).

